Mile Marker #9: Think It Through

The thinking behind the thinking, and your first STAR(T) draft.

In this module you learned to spot thinking traps and use the 4C Check to slow down before reacting. You also saw how that same thinking makes a STAR(T) story more honest and specific. This Mile Marker has two parts: a look at your own thinking patterns, and your first STAR(T) draft, a real starting point for your capstone.

For in-person classes. Fill in this handout by hand, then upload a photo or scan to the Mile Marker #9 assignment in Blackboard. You can also type in the boxes and save it as a PDF.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

Part I: Know Your Pattern

QUESTION 1

Name Your Pattern and a Better Question

Which thinking trap or bias from this module feels most like you?

A strong answer *Names one pattern, gives a real example, offers a better question, and names one strategy for slowing down.*

1. Choose the pattern that feels most like you. *(choose one)*

☐ Jumping to conclusions ☐ All-or-nothing thinking ☐ Overgeneralizing ☐ Mind reading

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ Confirmation bias ☐ Familiarity bias ☐ Halo effect ☐ Negativity bias

☐ Something else (describe it in the example)

2. Give a real example of a time this pattern showed up in your life.

3. Write one question you could ask yourself instead, the next time it shows up.

4. Name one strategy that helps you slow down and think more clearly.

Part II: Your First STAR(T) Draft

QUESTION 2

Tell Your Story

Pick one real experience, from this semester or the recent past, and write it out using all five STAR(T) steps.

***A strong answer** Includes all five steps, uses "I" in the Action, and sounds like you.*

1. Situation: What was going on?

2. Task: What needed to happen, and what was your role?

3. Action: What did you specifically do? Not the group. You.

4. Result: What happened?

5. Transfer: Why does this matter going forward, for your next class, a future job, or your life?

QUESTION 3

Check It with the 4Cs

Reread your draft using the 4C Check and answer honestly. Then revise at least one part of your draft.

A strong answer *Answers honestly, and shows a real revision to at least one step.*

1. Clarity and Context: Is your Situation clear, or does it need more detail?

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2. Credibility: Is everything in your Action and Result accurate, or did you round up?

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3. Consequences: Does your Transfer say something specific, or could it apply to anyone?

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4. Describe what you revised, and why.

QUESTION 4

Name the Skill

You'll confirm your four capstone skills later, so for now, take your best guess.

A strong answer *Names one skill and connects it to something specific in your story.*

1. Name the Essential Skill this story connects to, and explain why.